Sesame Turquoise Baker

People & Culture leader, Copenhagen

Clear. Candid. Human.

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PROFILE

I bring clarity to complexity, challenge thinking and make things happen, bringing people with me.

I've spent over 15 years working across the full HR landscape, from operations and business partnering to talent development, executive leadership and global transformation. My career spans international businesses including Siemens, LEGO, Lantmännen Unibake and Carlsberg, as well as a tech scale-up and a start-up.

I'm strategic in how I think, hands-on in how I work, and direct and collaborative in how I communicate. I believe in asking the questions that need asking, staying curious, listening to different perspectives and following through on what we set out to achieve.

I'm looking for a senior People & Culture role in Talent Management, Leadership or HR Transformation, or a CPO role where these come together. Open to permanent, interim and fixed-term roles, and available immediately.

EXPERIENCE

Career break

May 2026 – Present

Professional development

- Completed System Thinking (MIT xPRO) and passed the Danish citizenship test; currently learning about leading for neurodiversity.

Global Head of HR Transformation

Nov 2024 – May 2026

YNV Group · Remote

Privately held investment and operating group in technology, financial services and real estate, around 6,000 employees. Core team of 3 direct reports.

- Building the foundations for HR transformation across 11 countries: working with the CHRO, my team and I led 12 transformation projects, with foundations first: data, process and governance before AI.
- Launched a Shared Services hub in Africa in four months, rolling out to six countries and supporting around 3,000 leaders and employees, with 80% SLA compliance and customer satisfaction of 4.8/5. Created a roadmap for the rest-of-world roll-out.
- Established Microsoft Dynamics 365 (D365) as the single source of People data and replaced a legacy project structure with a functional hierarchy, reducing organisational units by 70% while keeping reporting lines and introducing consistent definitions (no job cuts). Gave leaders BI reporting for budgeting and workforce planning.
- Centralised employee documentation across 11 countries in D365, reducing audit risk and GDPR exposure. Audited 300+ contractors and brought around 90 approved contractors into D365 with approval workflows, bringing together HR, IT, Procurement, Finance and business leaders.
- Built two People & Culture knowledge sites (one for all employees, one for the international HR team), which became the foundation for an ‘Ask HR’ AI agent proof of concept.

Chief People Officer

May 2022 – Nov 2024

Uniscale (formerly Patientsky) · Copenhagen

Patientsky: healthcare SaaS company with around 300 employees. After the sale of its software business to EG, Uniscale (a software development platform) was formed. Team of 4 direct reports.

- Executive People leader and adviser to the CEO and leadership team through commercial scale-up and a company sale.
- Part of the M&A team for the sale of Patientsky’s software business to EG (NOK 850m+, March 2023), ensuring accurate and timely People data and documentation and supporting the HR due diligence.
- Designed a scalable People operating model; partnered the executive team on organisation design and workforce planning.
- Created a job architecture and pay grades, establishing career pathways and pay ranges to support hiring, pay equity, performance discussions and workforce budgeting.

- Built a customer experience team in Copenhagen and a sales hub in Barcelona as the company moved from R&D to a commercial organisation.
- Introduced performance standards and calibration for the leadership team, and defined succession for critical roles. Coached C-suite leaders.
- Led headcount reductions under Danish law with an employment lawyer: led all conversations, worked alongside the CEO and leadership team in every step, and trained managers to handle the conversations well.

Global Talent Development Director
Jan 2021 – Apr 2022

Lantmännen Unibake · Copenhagen

- Working with the CHRO, led global talent reviews and succession planning across 12 countries, and developed executive talent dashboards and competency frameworks.
- Designed and rolled out Leadership Fundamentals training for around 500 leaders, covering essential HR processes, feedback, coaching and DEI, through a cost-effective train-the-trainer model.
- Facilitated team development days and designed a global competency framework proof of concept for HR, Marketing & Sales, and Procurement.

Senior Global Talent Manager
Mar 2019 – Dec 2020

Carlsberg Group · Copenhagen

- Managed the Global Leadership Academy (budget around €1m), together with the CHRO and a business development colleague, working with external providers on programmes for leaders at all levels, including the Executive Leadership Team.
- Co-created the Carlsberg Leadership Framework and the revised values, and contributed to Carlsberg's first Diversity, Equity & Inclusion strategy and roadmap. Created a COVID-19 toolbox for leaders.
- Took part in design-thinking HR process sprints, facilitated by Implement Consulting, to improve core HR processes.

Global HR Development Manager
Nov 2017 – Feb 2019

TAJCO Group A/S · Vejle

Global supplier of premium exterior trim to the automotive industry, with R&D in Germany and China and manufacturing in China. Team of 2 direct reports.

- Led leadership and capability development across Europe, the US and China, including facilitating Situational Leadership II (SLII) training across sites.
- Standardised global HR development frameworks across leadership, values, talent and performance.
- Designed a skills and competency matrix for a 1,000-employee plant in Ningbo, China.
- Partnered on executive coaching and leadership hiring to strengthen critical capability and succession.

Senior Global Manager, Strategic HR Partner, LEGO Education
Dec 2016 – Nov 2017

The LEGO Group · Billund

- Strategic partner to the General Manager of LEGO Education and member of its leadership team through a rightsizing phase, leading organisation redesign for clearer structure and accountability.
- Built the business case for a new global onboarding model, setting out the financial, performance and social costs of poor onboarding, and co-designed the model to protect LEGO culture through high growth.

Senior Global Talent Manager, Executive HR
Dec 2015 – Nov 2016

The LEGO Group · Billund

- Matured the global performance management framework and delivered executive talent insight to the Executive Leadership Team.
- Trained the HR community on performance management, with a focus on DEI and reducing bias.

Head of HR Service Desk & International Mobility
Dec 2013 – Nov 2015

Siemens Wind Power · Brande

Led two teams: International Mobility (12) and AskHR (6).

- Led AskHR for around 7,000 employees: around 3,500 queries a month and 8/10 customer satisfaction. In the 2014 Siemens global maturity assessment, rated "World Class" by Siemens HQ for 100% employee reach and for resolving over 90% of queries first time.
- Customer Satisfaction Lead for Northwest Europe.

- Managed around 2,000 international delegations a year and supported the move of centres of expertise to Prague, Lisbon and India.
- Led change and communication for the OneHR strategy in Denmark as part of the HR leadership team, including a management roadshow, change agents and pulse checks.

Manager, AskHR (HR Service Desk) — Sep 2012 – Dec 2013

Siemens Wind Power · Brande

Team of 6 direct reports.

- Key member of the project team that designed and implemented HR Shared Services, then set up and led AskHR, the single point of contact for HR for around 7,000 employees across 15 sites in Denmark, reaching 81.5% first-time resolution.

HR Business Partner — Sep 2010 – Sep 2012

Siemens Wind Power · Brande

- HR Business Partner to leaders across Global Projects, Sales & Marketing, Service and EMEA, supporting populations of 250 to 1,500; partnered leaders on organisation design, workforce planning and performance.

Business Development & Strategy Coordinator — Jul 2008 – Sep 2010

Siemens Wind Power · Brande

- Supported the Director of Business Development & Strategy on global market planning.

CERTIFICATIONS

- System Thinking, MIT xPRO, 2026
- Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I), Scrum.org, 2026
- Introduction to Project Management, IBM (Coursera), 2026
- Co-Active Professional Coach, CTI (104 hours, ICF-accredited), 2024
- Fundamentals of AI in HR, Hacking HR, 2024
- Certified Professional Change Management (CPCM), 2023
- Co-Active Leadership Experience, CTI, 2022
- Leading L&D, Josh Bersin Academy, 2021
- Positive Psychology, University of Pennsylvania, 2021
- Hogan Assessment Certification, 2018
- Situational Leadership II (SLII) Train the Trainer, Blanchard, 2017
- DISC and GIA Certified, Thomas International, 2011

SKILLS

Talent & Leadership: Talent & Succession | Leadership Development | Performance Management | Competency Frameworks | People Analytics | Executive Coaching | Facilitation | DEI

HR Transformation: HR Operating Models | Shared Services | HR Service Delivery | HRIS & People Data (D365) | Practical AI in HR | Change Management | Systems Thinking | Programme & Portfolio Management

HR Business Partnering: Organisation Design | Workforce Planning | Employee Experience & Onboarding | International Mobility | M&A People Data | Danish Employment Law in Practice | Stakeholder Management

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

HNC Business Management (Merit), Arden University, 2018

English (native), Danish (working knowledge, FVU Level 3)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

British citizen, living in Denmark since 2006 with permanent residence. Passed the Danish citizenship test (Indfødsretsprøven), June 2026. Happy to travel.

Outside work, I love the arts, reading, live music, nature and architecture. Favourite places: Being by the sea, Louisiana Museum of Modern Art, where art, architecture and nature meet, and Glyptoteket.